

FLAN



YIELD 8 servings	ACTIVE TIME 15 min	REST 4 h chill, or overnight	OVEN 350F, 40-45 min in a water bath
ENERGY COST \$2.58 (45 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)			

INGREDIENTS

4 large	Eggs
2 large	Egg yolks
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt
1 can, 14 oz	Sweetened condensed milk
1 can, 12 oz	Evaporated milk
	Vanilla paste: 1 tsp, or half a vanilla bean, or 1 tbsp extract
1 cup	Granulated sugar, for the caramel
1/4 cup	Water, for the caramel
a pinch	Kosher salt, for the caramel

METHOD

- Heat the oven to 350F and set up a water bath. A 9 inch cake pan inside a roasting pan works.
- Blend the eggs, yolks, salt, both milks and the vanilla about 30 seconds, until smooth. Do not aerate it. If it froths, let it settle.
- Caramel: dissolve the sugar in the water over medium-low heat.
- Turn the heat to high and boil about 5 minutes, until it goes from clear to light gold. The boiling is what drives the water off.
- As soon as it turns light gold, drop to medium-low and take it to a proper golden brown.
- Pour into the pan at once and swirl to coat the base. It sets fast, so move quickly, and the pan will be very hot.
- Let the caramel harden about 5 minutes.
- Stir the custard, pour it over the set caramel, and cover tightly with foil.
- Sit it in the water bath and fill with hot water from a kettle.
- Bake 40 to 45 minutes, until just jiggly but set.
- Cool 30 minutes on the counter, then chill at least 4 hours or overnight.
- Run a knife round the edge, invert onto a plate, smack the base to release.

NOTES

Blend rather than whisk, but stop at smooth. Bubbles blended in become holes in the set custard.
 The 5 minute hard boil on the caramel is deliberate: it removes water so the caramel sets instead of staying syrupy.
 Two cans plus 6 eggs total is a dense, firm flan rather than a loose one.
 The chill is not optional. It will not unmould cleanly warm.